Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. I have experience building and operating production data platforms across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, and I am drawn to the opportunity to help Halden Pay build shared, reliable platform capabilities for its product and analytics teams.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform. I designed a shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95, and replaced hourly full-table extracts with Debezium CDC, reducing replica CPU during loads from around 70% to 25%. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to tested and documented dbt models, cutting the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. These projects reflect my focus on reliable data, practical modeling and simplifying platform operations. I have also reduced Snowflake spend through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.

Earlier, at Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR and developed a transaction reconciliation engine that matched bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance's manual work from around three days to four hours per month-end. Alongside my production work, I have contributed fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider, mentor two engineers, and hold an MSc in Computer Science. I would bring hands-on experience with comparable cloud data platforms, Python, SQL, Airflow and dbt, as well as a practical interest in open-source tools and dependable data quality.

Halden Pay's emphasis on ownership, collaboration and reducing unnecessary complexity resonates with how I approach platform work: take responsibility for the systems people depend on, improve them in measurable ways, and make them easier for colleagues to use. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm